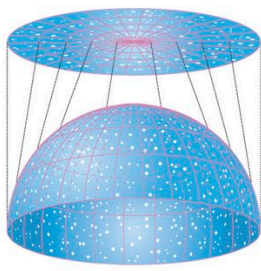


The northern sky

A star map of the northern sky is a flattened picture that shows some of the constellations seen from the northern hemisphere (that's anywhere north of the equator). Choose a clear night and look up. If you live near the equator, you won't be able to spot all these stars all year.



A star map of the northern sky



Imagine the Earth surrounded by a sphere of stars. The northern sky map is taken from the top half of that sphere.

Which way?

Travellers in the northern hemisphere can easily find their way by following Polaris, or the North Star, because it lies almost directly above the North Pole. If you spot Polaris, you will know which way is north and can work out which way you need to go.



As the Earth turns, Polaris stays put in the sky because it is above the North Pole. The other stars appear to travel round it.

